



CIG NEXUS

Brand & Design System

The first brand charter for the CIG Nexus web client: what ships today, a revision informed by Discord and 2026 trends, and a catalog of 17 themes.

AS-BUILT

Documented from the code on main. Values verified against the repo.

PROPOSED

New in this document. Needs a decision before anyone implements it.

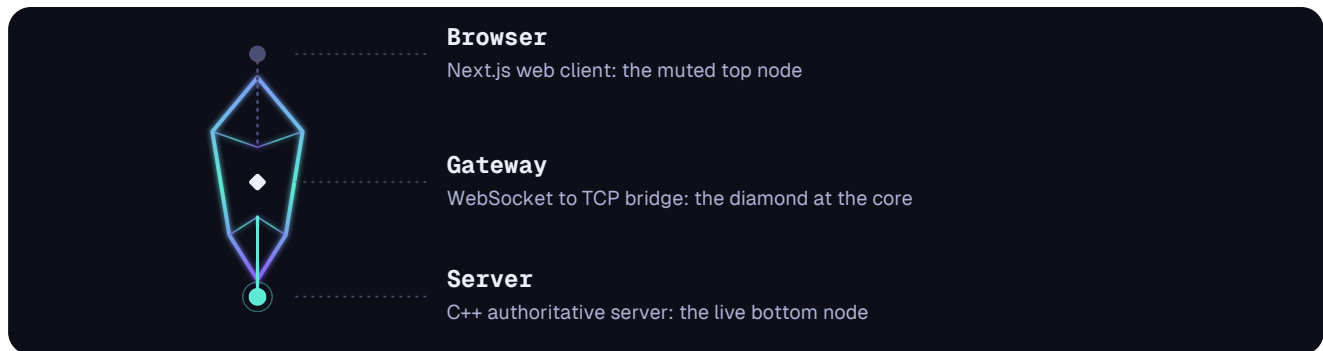
v0.4 · 2026-10-03 · source of truth: `web/app/globals.css`, `web/lib/appearance/themes.ts`
companion files: `docs/design/brand-guidelines.md`, `theme-catalog.css`, `theme-catalog.json`

1 Brand

1.1 Essence AS-BUILT

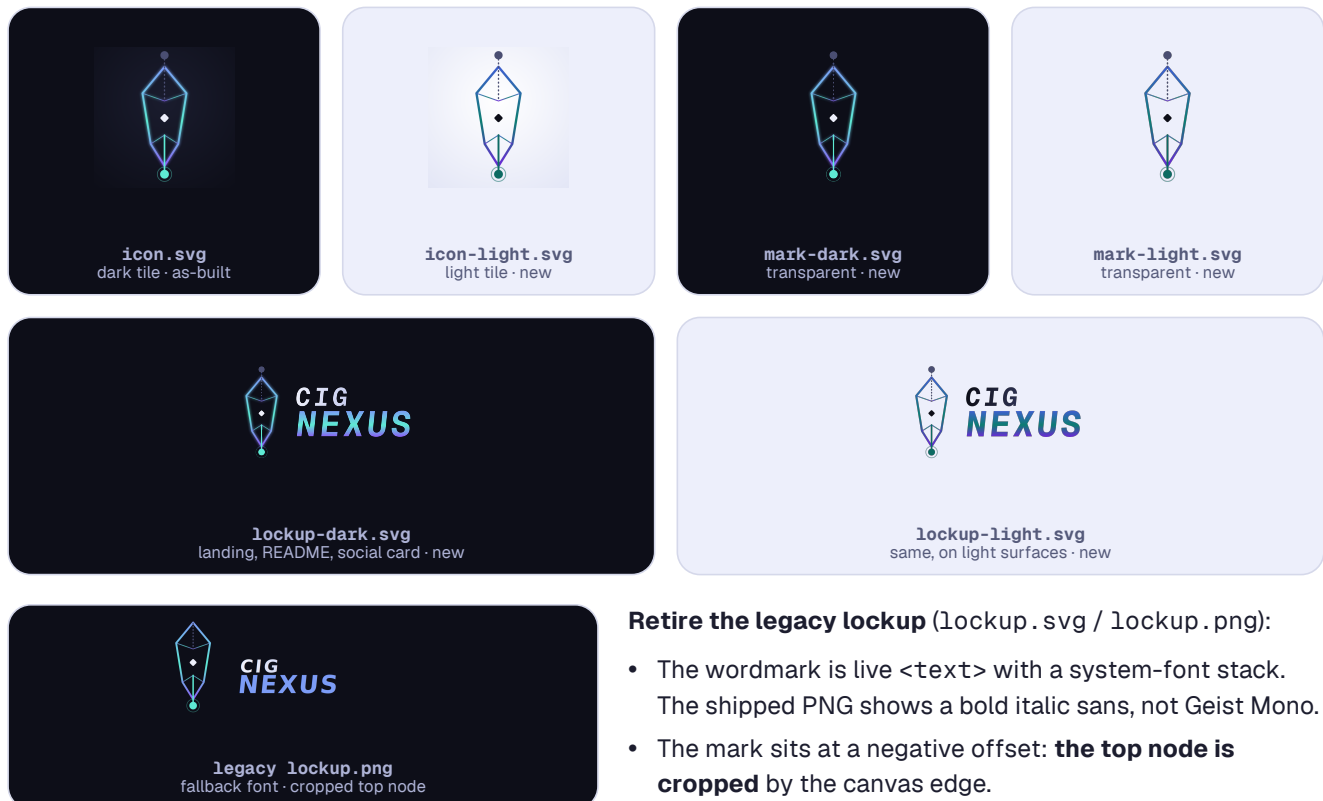
CIG Nexus is a lightweight real-time chat platform that keeps transport, protocol and UI cleanly separated. The identity follows from that: an **instrument panel**, not a social app. Dark by default, a monospace voice, one bright accent on a quiet ink background.

The mark is a crystal shard in line art. The three nodes on its vertical axis read as the platform's three hops. (The SVG only says "three-hop topology"; the browser / gateway / server mapping is an interpretation of the architecture.)



1.2 Logo family AS-BUILT + new files

Every mark shares the same 512x512 canvas and geometry, so any mark-* or icon-* file is a drop-in replacement for another in `<Image>`.



Retire the legacy lockup (lockup.svg / lockup.png):

- The wordmark is live `<text>` with a system-font stack. The shipped PNG shows a bold italic sans, not Geist Mono.
- The mark sits at a negative offset: **the top node is cropped** by the canvas edge.
- The canvas is 1000x300 but the artwork stops near x=600.
- The dark background is baked in, so it cannot sit on a light surface.

Light variants are not simple recolors

On a light background the same gradient washes out. mark-light and lockup-light use deeper gradient stops (blue #3f5fd0, teal #0d7d72, violet #6d28d9), a dark central diamond, no glow, and strokes about 20% heavier: dark-on-light reads thinner than light-on-dark. With 17 themes, two colorways cannot match every palette: see the inline themed <Mark> (5.3, item 5).

1.3 Wordmark AS-BUILT

Two treatments exist today. Keep both, with fixed jobs.

	STACKED LOCKUP WORDMARK	IN-APP INLINE WORDMARK
Where	lockup files, README, social cards	Logo.tsx: header and landing page
Face	Geist Mono Bold, skewed -6 degrees	Geist Mono Bold (font-mono font-bold)
Layout	CIG over NEXUS, size ratio 0.72	one line: CIG NEXUS
Tracking	about 0.11em (CIG) / 0.06em (NEXUS)	tracking-[0.2em]
Color	CIG solid, NEXUS in the brand gradient	CIG text-fg, NEXUS text-brand (follows the theme)
Sizes	n/a	text-sm beside a 28px mark; text-3x1 beside 64px

Rule: product UI uses the inline wordmark (live text, follows the theme); static artwork uses the stacked lockup. Never retype the wordmark in another typeface.

1.4 Clear space and minimum size PROPOSED

- Clear space:** at least the cap height of "CIG" on every side of a lockup (about 10% of its width). The files carry a smaller built-in margin; add more next to other elements.
- Minimum size:** mark 24px tall (the product uses 28, 44 and 64); icon tile 16px, favicon only (always the dark tile icon.svg: the light tile loses its edge on light surfaces); lockup 120px wide.



1.5 Usage rules PROPOSED

Do pick the variant by the background actually behind the logo, keep the proportions, and scale uniformly. **Do not** add outlines or effects, put a glow on the light variants, or place the gradient mark on mid-tone or photographic backgrounds (use the baked tile). Examples:



2 Color

2.1 Token architecture AS-BUILT

Eleven tokens in a Tailwind v4 `@theme` block in `web/app/globals.css`: `page`, `surface`, `raised`, `slate`, `fg`, `muted`, `brand`, `brand-2`, `danger`, `warning`, `online` (the last five arrived in PR #65). Every color utility compiles against `var(--color-...)`, so a `[data-theme]` block that redeclares tokens re-skins the whole app with no component changes. There is deliberately no `Abyss` block: the `@theme` defaults are `Abyss`. The theme is a `data-theme` attribute on `<html>`, set server-side from a cookie. Section 2.7 lists them. `raised` and `warning` are defined but no component uses them yet: Tailwind v4 emits a theme variable only when a utility uses it, so they are absent from the compiled CSS until a migration uses them. `muted` has been emitted since PR #67.

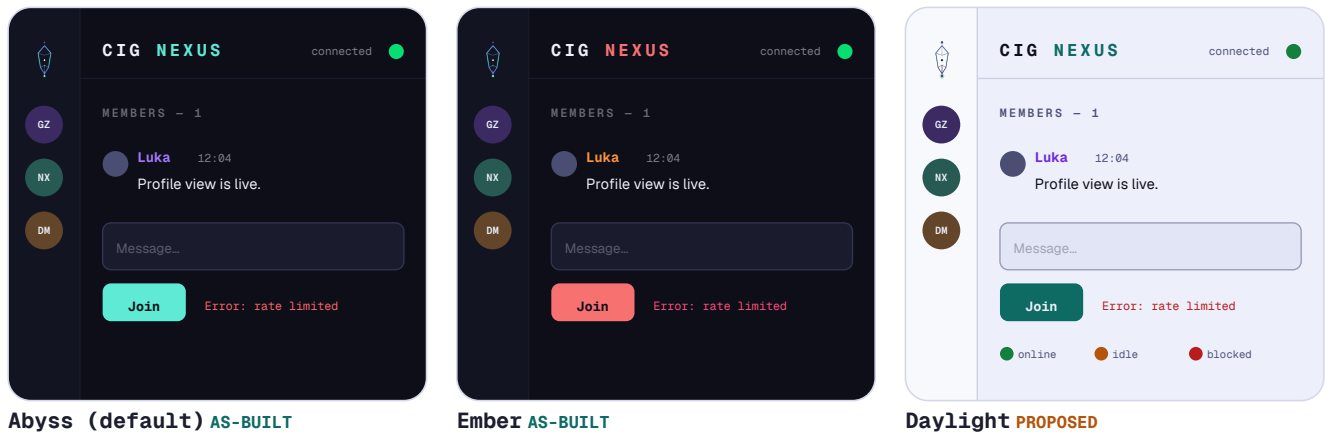
Renamed in PR #63. The old names described colors, and in a light theme or in `Ember` they were wrong (a teal that is coral, an ink that is white).

WAS	NOW	ROLE
ink	page	page background
ivory	fg	primary text
teal	brand	primary accent
violet	brand-2	secondary accent

accent and text were rejected: accent collides with Tailwind's native `accent-*` utility (it would read `accent-accent`) and text would read `text-text`. Usage on main (after PR #70): 222 token-utility uses (fg 60, brand 63 including one `accent-brand`, muted 50, page 23, danger 18, online 5, brand-2 3; raised and warning 0), all literal class strings. **One hazard the rename exposed:** Tailwind emits rules in an order that depends on class names, so a rename can change which of two same-property utilities wins on one element. PR #63 found one case (the `Friends` button in the rail, whose active icon would have turned grey) and fixed it. See the rule in section 8.

2.2 Palettes

Roles are positional, not literal: in a light theme `page` is the light page color and `fg` the dark text color. **Daylight is an exact inversion of Abyss**, so primary text keeps the same contrast (16.8:1). The first two cards draw what ships (opacity tiers for secondary text, since `muted` and `raised` are not used yet); `Daylight` is drawn with the new tokens.



TOKEN	ROLE	ABYSS	EMBER	DAYLIGHT
page	page background	#0d0e18	#0d0e18	#edeffb
surface	panels, rail, cards	#1a1c2e	#1a1c2e	#ffffff
raised	hover, selected, input fill	#252840	#252840	#e2e5f6
slate	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)	#4a4e72	#4a4e72	#4a4e72
fg	primary text	#edeffb	#edeffb	#0d0e18
muted	secondary text, solid	#9aa0c8	#9aa0c8	#4d5278
brand	primary accent	#5eead4	#f87171	#0d6b63

TOKEN	ROLE	ABYSS	EMBER	DAYLIGHT
brand-2	secondary accent	#a079f8	#fb923c	#6d28d9
danger	errors, blocked	#ff6467	#ff4d79	#b91c1c
warning	idle, caution	#fbbf24	#fbbf24	#b45309
online	online dot	#05df72	#05df72	#15803d

Ember overrides brand, brand-2 and danger; every other token inherits Abyss. danger and online are tokens since PR #65 and carry Tailwind v4's red-400 and green-400, which v4 defines in OKLCH (oklch(70.4% 0.191 22.216) and oklch(79.2% 0.209 151.711)); the hex above is the sRGB approximation. **The first draft of this charter gave the Tailwind v3 hex values (#f87171, #4ade80), which was wrong for this project.** Before PR #65, Ember's accent and its danger color were nearly identical (OKLab distance 2.5 x100, about one just-noticeable difference; the first draft overstated it as "the same color"); Ember's own danger #ff4d79 is at 6.8. Brand blue #7c9cf6 exists only in the logo gradient.

Accent contrast (WCAG 2.x)

PAIR	RATIO	NOTE
Abyss brand on page	13.0	
Abyss brand-2 before PR #65 (#8b5cf6) on page	4.5	
Abyss brand-2 before PR #65 on surface	4.0	below 4.5 (usernames on panels)
Abyss brand-2 now (#a079f8) on page / surface / raised	—	6.0 / 5.3 / 4.5
Ember brand / brand-2 on page	—	6.9 / 8.5
Abyss brand on Daylight page	1.3	unusable, hence a new teal
Abyss brand-2 on Daylight page	3.7	too low for small text
Daylight brand on page	5.6	6.4 on surface
Daylight brand-2 on page	6.2	
Daylight button: page text on brand	5.6	4.6 on brand/90 (hover)

2.3 Text opacity tiers AS-BUILT

Hierarchy is made with opacity on fg, not with extra tokens. Numbers are contrast on the page background; **red** is below 4.5:1.

	text-fg	text-fg/90	text-fg/80	text-fg/70	text-fg/60	text-fg/50	text-fg/40	text-fg/30
Abyss on page	Aa 16.8	Aa 13.6	Aa 10.8	Aa 8.4	Aa 6.4	Aa 4.8	Aa 3.5	Aa 2.5
Daylight on page	Aa 16.8	Aa 13.4	Aa 9.7	Aa 6.8	Aa 4.8	Aa 3.5	Aa 2.6	Aa 2.0

UTILITY	USES	TYPICAL ROLE
text-fg	38×	primary text
text-fg/90	3×	list-row names
text-fg/80	1×	bio / long-form
text-fg/70	1×	one icon
text-fg/60	0×	none left (migrated to muted in PR #67)
text-fg/50	10×	icons only (8, plus 2 raised from /40)
text-fg/40	0×	none left (migrated to muted in PR #67)

UTILITY	USES	TYPICAL ROLE
text-fg/30	4x	placeholders, disabled

Rule, as-built since PR #67: informational text is fg or the solid muted token, both AA in every theme. The opacity tiers are for decoration and icons: placeholders, disabled states, hover tints, dividers, and 11 icon uses (10 at /50, one at /70). A test scans web/app and web/components and fails on any text-fg/40 to /70 outside an allowlist keyed by file, class and count. **The allowlist is valid for dark themes only:** icons need 3:1, and /50 measures 2.2 to 2.9:1 on five of the six light catalog themes (2.6, item 7).

2.4 Borders, tints, overlays AS-BUILT

- border-slate/20 (21x) dividers; border-slate/40 (21x) controls; text inputs use /50.
- Panels bg-surface; translucent rails bg-surface/40-60; active tint bg-brand/10-25.
- Backdrops bg-page/40, bg-page/70; elevated cards shadow-x1.

2.5 Colors that do not follow the theme AS-BUILT

- **Status colors** (PresenceDot, SignalIndicator, error text): green means online and red means error in every theme, so switching themes never makes “connected” read as an error. Since PR #65 the values are tokens (online, danger) that keep Tailwind's green-400 and red-400 in Abyss, so each theme can tune them for its own backgrounds. **Five red-300 uses remain literal**, in three files: the error banner text and its dismiss x, and the reject buttons of JoinRequestInbox and FriendRequestsPopover. A lighter red used as text on a red-tinted background: readable on dark themes, not on light ones (1.7:1 on Daylight). See 5.3, item 9.
- **Guild icons** [fixed in PR #61]: background hsl (hue, 45%, 30%) with the hue hashed from the guild id, initials in a fixed #edeffb (web/lib/guildIconColor.ts). Neither follows the theme, by design. A test sweeps all 360 hues and asserts at least 4.5:1.
- **The brand gradient**, which exists only in logo artwork.

2.6 Accessibility findings

Targets: 4.5:1 for text, 3:1 for icons, dots and logo strokes. Opacity-tier figures use sRGB alpha blending; Tailwind v4 blends in OKLab, so real values differ by a few tenths: confirm in DevTools. Solid-color figures (the catalog) do not have this caveat.

1. **The muted tier was below AA even in Abyss** [resolved in PR #67]. text-fg/40 was the most used tier (40 uses) and the style of 18 of the 19 uppercase labels: 3.5:1 in Abyss, 2.6:1 in Daylight. /60 gives 6.4 and 4.8. All 49 informational uses moved to text-muted.
2. **A stricter opacity rule does not scale across themes.** The first draft proposed “/60 or stronger”. Tested on the catalog it forces soft light-theme text to near-black: Latte's #4c4f69 would become #0f1015, Dawn's #464261 #15141d, Parchment's #3c3836 #060606, erasing what makes those themes themselves. A solid muted per theme (what Discord, Catppuccin and Rose Pine all do) keeps identity and gives AA by construction.
3. **Abyss brand-2 on surface was 4.0:1** (usernames) [resolved in PR #65]: it is now #a079f8, 4.5:1 on the weakest surface.
4. **Status colors fail on light backgrounds:** Tailwind's red-400 is 2.5:1 and green-400 1.6:1 on Daylight page, and the five red-300 uses are 1.7:1. The tokens now exist, so Daylight can define its own (#b91c1c, #15803d); the red-300 uses still need a decision (5.3, item 9).
5. **Guild initials** [resolved in PR #61]: #edeffb on the guild background was 4.17:1 at the worst hue (60). At 30% lightness the worst case is 4.60:1, which is what shipped, with a 360-hue test.
6. **color-scheme** [resolved in PR #65]: no theme declared it, so native scrollbars, form controls and autofill used the browser's default (light) styling on the dark default. :root now declares color-scheme: dark, and every catalog block sets its own.
7. **Icons at /50 fail 3:1 on light themes** (new). The 11 icon uses kept in PR #67 are fine on every dark theme (worst case 3.06:1, Ash) but measure 2.2:1 on Latte, 2.3 on Parchment, 2.4 on Dawn, 2.7 on Chalk and 2.9 on Cloud (Daylight, 3.4, passes). Harmless while only dark themes ship; they must move to a solid token before the first light theme (5.4, PR L2).
8. **The author name is 12px**, not 14px as the earlier drafts said: the row is font-mono text-xs and the name only adds font-semibold text-brand-2. With message bodies at 16px (PR #70) the author-to-body ratio went from 0.86 to 0.75. It was left at 12px on purpose; text-sm (0.875) is the one-line option if the author line feels

small.

2.7 Token set v0.2 AS-BUILT since PR #65

Eleven tokens, all on main. Four were renamed in PR #63 (2.1); five were added in PR #65.

TOKEN	ROLE	STATUS	WHY
page	page background	as-built (was ink)	renamed in PR #63
surface	panels, rail, cards	as-built	unchanged
raised	hover, selected rows, input fill	added in PR #65, unused so far	Discord stacks three surface levels; CIG has two, so hover and inputs still borrow translucent tints
slate	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)	as-built	unchanged
fg	primary text	as-built (was ivory)	renamed in PR #63; AAA on page and surface in every catalog theme
muted	secondary text, a solid color	added in PR #65, used since PR #67 (50 uses)	replaced informational use of fg/40 to /70; AA by construction
brand	primary accent	as-built (was teal)	renamed in PR #63; most catalog themes use a non-teal hue
brand-2	secondary accent	as-built (was violet)	renamed in PR #63; Abyss value lightened in PR #65
danger	errors, blocked	added in PR #65 (was the red-400 literal)	per-theme tuning; Ember has its own
warning	idle, caution	added in PR #65, unused so far	idle presence and cautions have no color yet
online	online dot	added in PR #65 (was the green-400 literal)	per-theme tuning

What changed for Abyss and Ember in PR #65:

TOKEN	BEFORE	AFTER	NOTE
raised	none	#252840	one step above surface
muted	fg/40 to /70	#9aa0c8	about today's fg/60 on page; 5.7:1 on the weakest surface
brand-2 (Abyss)	#8b5cf6	#a079f8	lightness only; 4.5:1 on the weakest surface
danger (Ember)	red-400 (about #ff6467), nearly the accent's color	#ff4d79	distinct from the coral accent
warning	none	#fbbf24	amber, readable on every dark surface
danger, online (Abyss)	red-400, green-400 literals	the same two OKLCH values, as tokens	no visual change

Rename [done, PR #63]. The four renamed tokens no longer name a color, so the catalog can give brand a periwinkle, a mauve or a brick red without the code lying. See 2.1 for the mapping.

3 Typography

AS-BUILT Two families, loaded with next/font/google in layout.tsx and exposed as --font-geist-sans / --font-geist-mono.

GEIST MONO · FONT-MONO98 uses

CIG NEXUS

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789 ABCDEFG

The interface voice: headings, nav, buttons, labels, usernames, logo

GEIST SANS · FONT-SANS7 uses

Reading text

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789 ABCDEFG

Sentences the user reads: messages, inputs, bios, descriptions, landing copy

Rule: Geist Mono for anything the product says (chrome, names, labels); Geist Sans for anything the user reads in sentences.

Scale **AS-BUILT**

UTILITY	SIZE / LINE	USES	SAMPLE (Geist Mono Bold)	WHERE
text-xs	12 / 16	51	Aa Nexus	metadata, timestamps, author name, uppercase labels, badges
text-sm	14 / 20	36	Aa Nexus	default UI text
text-base	16 / 24	7	Aa Nexus	chat message body (leading-[1.375]), text inputs, landing paragraph
text-lg	18 / 28	3	Aa Nexus	occasional larger text
text-2xl	24 / 32	1	Aa Nexus	error page title
text-3xl	30 / 36	1	Aa Nexus	large inline wordmark
text-4xl → sm:text-5xl	36 → 48	1	Aa Nexus	landing headline
text-[10px], text-[9px]	10, 9	1, 2	ROLE	role badge and micro labels: the only off-scale sizes

Weights: font-semibold (600) is the default emphasis (41 uses); font-bold (700) for page titles and the wordmark (5); everything else is regular. **Tracking:** headlines tracking-tight; wordmark tracking-[0.2em].

MEMBERS — 1font-mono text-xs font-semibold tracking-wider uppercase text-muted

3.1 Revisions informed by Discord and 2026 trends PARTLY SHIPPED

- **Discord** runs one proprietary family, gg sans (since Dec 2022): chat text 16px at line height 1.375, usernames weight 500, timestamps 12px, section labels 12px / 600 / uppercase. gg sans is not available to us; the sizes transfer. (Sizes come from third-party analyses, not from Discord.)
- **2026 type roundups** agree: variable fonts are the default delivery format; Inter and Geist are the neutral UI workhorses; monospace as a brand voice is a recognized trend; 16px is the body floor, line height at least 1.4 for long reading, sizes in rem.
- **CIG is already on-trend on type.** Geist and Geist Mono are variable, neutral and named in 2026 roundups, and a monospace-led interface is the identity. **No font change is proposed.**

What changes is size, not family: chat messages are text-sm (14px), the density that Discord and the 16px floor both argue against for the main reading surface.

ROLE	BEFORE	NOW / PROPOSED	STATUS
Chat message body	Geist Sans 14 / 20, fg	Geist Sans 16 / 22 (text-base, leading-[1.375])	shipped, PR #70 (16px floor; Discord's 16 / 1.375)
Text inputs	Geist Sans 14	Geist Sans 16 ; bio textarea (Geist Mono) too	shipped, PR #70 (iOS Safari zooms below 16px)
Username	Geist Mono semibold 12 , brand-2	unchanged	left as is; see 2.6 item 8 for the text-sm option
Timestamp, metadata, helper	Geist Mono 12, fg/40 to /50	Geist Mono 12, muted	shipped, PR #67
Section label	mono 12 semibold, tracking-wider, uppercase, fg/40	same style, muted	shipped, PR #67
Bio display, long-form	Geist Sans 14, fg/80	Geist Sans 14 / 22 (leading-relaxed), fg	proposed
Role badge, micro labels	10px and 9px	12px (text-xs)	proposed (below the 12px floor today)

Keep sizes in rem, keep the variable font files, and treat APCA (the contrast model proposed for WCAG 3) as a later check, not a v0.2 requirement.

4 Shape, spacing and layout

AS-BUILT Everything below is measured from the components on main.

Radius



rounded-md
6px · controls, rows (35)



rounded-lg
8px · cards (8)



rounded-xl
12px · modals, popovers (7)

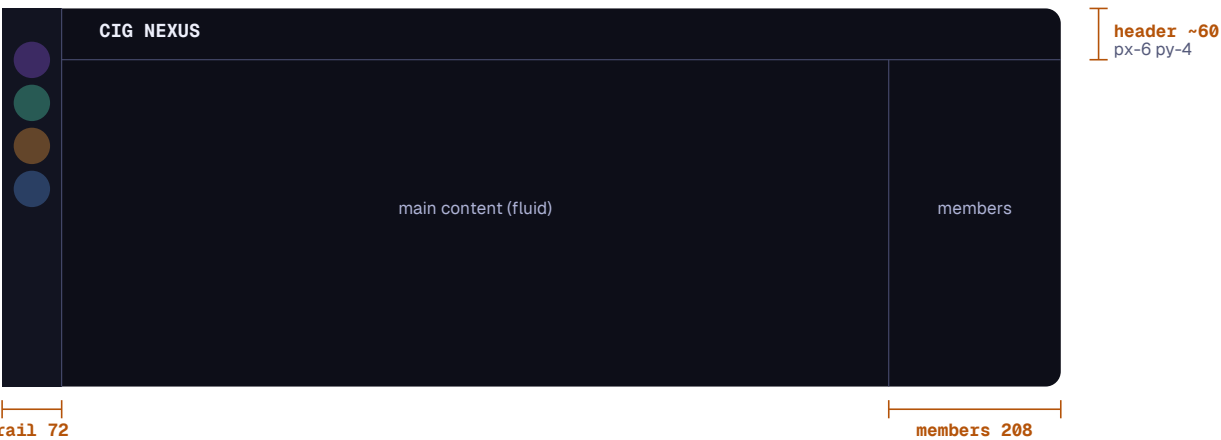


rounded-full
pill / circle · avatars, dots (19)

Spacing and borders

A 4px grid. Most used: gap-2 (8px, 29×), px-3 (12px, 18×), gap-1 (4px, 15×), py-1.5 (6px, 14×), py-2 (8px, 12×), p-3 (12px, 12×). Borders are always 1px, slate at partial opacity.

Layout constants



Schematic of a 1280 px window. Values in px, from GuildRail.tsx, MemberList.tsx and Header.tsx.

ELEMENT	SIZE
Guild rail	72px wide; buttons 44×44; dividers 32px wide, 1px
Active-guild pill	4×24px, rounded-r-full, bg-fg, 10px left of the button
Member list	208px wide (w-52), p-3
Header	px-6 py-4, bottom border slate/20
Popovers	288px wide (w-72)
Profile modal	max 384px (max-w-sm); 8px accent stripe in the user's accent (default #5eead4)
Settings modal	max 672px (max-w-2xl)
Avatars	20 (member rows, popovers), 24 (lists, settings), 28 (messages), 44 (rail), 64 (profile)

4.1 Discord-inspired details **PROPOSED** (optional)

- Three surface levels.** page < surface < raised mirrors Discord's three grays. Hover and selected rows would use bg-raised instead of translucent tints, which also keeps them legible in every theme.
- Guild icon shape.** Discord's server icons are rounded squares that become circles on hover. A radius transition from rounded-xl to rounded-full on hover and on the active guild is a small, cheap affordance.
- UI density.** Discord added a density option in March 2025. A data-density attribute scaling message-group spacing (for example 4 / 8 / 16px) is a candidate for a later release, not v0.2.

5 Theming

5.1 Adding a theme AS-BUILT

One CSS block plus one registry entry, never a change to a consuming component (appearance-design.md §2.2). An unknown id falls back to the default theme. Since PR #68 the registry also carries mode (dark or light), and users.theme is free text with no database constraint, so a new theme needs no migration.

5.2 Daylight PROPOSED

The first theme that flips the base palette instead of only swapping accents. It supersedes the “dark-only by design” scope-out in appearance-design.md. Values are the v0.2 set of 11 tokens.

```
[data-theme="daylight"] {
  color-scheme: light;
  --color-page: #edeffb;           /* page background */
  --color-surface: #ffffff;        /* panels, rail, cards */
  --color-raised: #e2e5f6;        /* hover, selected, input fill */
  --color-slate: #4a4e72;        /* borders at /20-/50 */
  --color-fg: #0d0e18;           /* primary text */
  --color-muted: #4d5278;        /* secondary text */
  --color-brand: #0d6b63;        /* primary accent */
  --color-brand-2: #6d28d9;      /* secondary accent */
  --color-danger: #b91c1c;       /* errors, blocked */
  --color-warning: #b45309;      /* idle, caution */
  --color-online: #15803d;       /* online dot */
}

// web/lib/appearance/themes.ts
{ id: "daylight", label: "Daylight", swatch: { accent: "#0d6b63", secondary: "#6d28d9" } },
```

Why these values. fg and page are an exact inversion of Abyss, so primary text keeps 16.8:1. Teal is the lightest of its ramp for which both text-brand and the primary button's hover (page text on bg-brand/90, 4.6:1) stay at or above 4.5:1. Slate is unchanged because it is only used at partial opacity.

5.3 Required follow-ups for Daylight and the catalog PROPOSED

1. **Guild icon initials:** done in PR #61 (fixed #edeffb, 30% lightness, tested at all 360 hues). Nothing left to do.
2. **New tokens:** done in PR #65 (raised, muted, warning, danger, online). The red-400 and green-400 literals became danger and online (23 uses); muted has 50 uses since PR #67, while raised and warning are defined but still unused.
3. **Migrate informational text:** done in PR #67 (49 uses to text-muted; 11 icon uses kept, with a guard test).
4. **color-scheme:** done in PR #65 (:root declares dark, and each catalog block sets its own).
5. **Logo in the UI:** partly done. PR #69 replaced the baked navy tile with the transparent mark-dark.svg (header, rail, landing, login-error) and kept icon.svg for the favicon: right for every dark theme. For light themes and per-accent colors: A, static assets swapped by CSS (the blue-teal gradient stays fixed and clashes with some of the 17 themes), or B, one inline <Mark> whose gradient reads CSS variables. **Recommendation: B** (5.4, PR L1); static files stay for favicon, README and social cards.
6. **Manual pass** on every view in each theme that ships. There is no visual-regression suite, so cost scales with the number of themes (7.20).
7. **Docs:** update appearance-design.md in the PR that ships the first new theme. The CLAUDE.md row for this charter already landed in PR #62.
8. **Drift guard:** done in PR #68. A test compares each registry swatch with its theme block's brand and brand-2, and DEFAULT_ACCENT (#5eead4, in ProfileView and ProfileSettings) with Abyss's brand.
9. **red-300 (5 uses, 3 files):** the error banner text, its dismiss × and two reject buttons use a lighter red on a red-tinted background, illegible on a light theme (1.7:1 on Daylight). Recommended: switch them to text-danger in the PR of the first light theme, with a visual check in every theme; a dedicated danger-fg token is the alternative if text-danger proves too strong on dark tints. Not now: it would change Abyss's error styling for no benefit yet.

5.4 Light-theme readiness PROPOSED

The first light theme needs four things the dark themes did not. Suggested order, one PR each (L2 and L3 can share one if the visual check is shared):

PR	SCOPE	WHY IT BLOCKS LIGHT THEMES	VISIBLE IN DARK THEMES
L1	Inline <Mark> reading brand, brand-2, fg, muted; replaces the mark-dark image in Logo and the rail button	the dark mark vanishes on a light page and cannot follow the accent	logo colors follow each theme (Abyss loses the blue top stop)
L2	the 11 icon uses from /50 and /70 to text-muted; empty the guard test allowlist	/50 is 2.2 to 2.9:1 on five of six light themes	icons slightly brighter
L3	the five red-300 uses to text-danger	red-300 is 1.7:1 on Daylight	error banner, dismiss, reject buttons slightly stronger red
L4	Daylight and Cloud: blocks (color-scheme: light), registry entries with mode light, tests; the picker gets a second group	needs L1 to L3	none (new themes only)

Design points for L1: a vertical gradient from brand to brand-2; the dotted line and top node in muted; the diamond in fg; the hub in brand. A soft glow suits dark themes and muddies light ones: either set a data-mode attribute next to data-theme (the registry already has mode) and enable the glow only for dark, or drop the glow. Needs a visual check in all six shipped themes, since the logo changes color in each.

6 Research basis

6.1 Discord

Discord's own support pages and blog give the structure (four themes, sync options, density); community extractions give the hex values. **Discord does not publish its design tokens**, so every hex below is a community extraction: consistent across several sources, not an official spec.

OBSERVATION	VALUE	CIG DECISION
Four base themes: Light, Ash, Dark, Onyx (Onyx is true black, for OLED)	official: support pages, Mar 2025 desktop update, 2026 mobile update	Adapt: Chalk, Ash, Onyx join the catalog
“Sync with computer” and a choice of which light and which dark theme to use	official	Adapt: system mode, 7.21
Three dark surface levels: server rail, sidebar, chat	#1e1f22, #2b2d31, #313338 (community)	Adapt: page / surface / raised ramp
Light surfaces	#ffffff, #f2f3f5, #e3e5e8 (community)	Chalk reference
One saturated accent	blurple #5865f2 (official brand)	Keep the one-accent discipline
Solid text tiers, not opacity	#dbdee1 normal, #b5bac1 muted (community)	Adopt: solid muted token
Status colors	red #f23f43, green #23a55a (community)	Adopt: danger, online, plus warning
Typeface gg sans, 16px chat text, 1.375 line height	font official; sizes from third-party analyses	Adapt: 16px chat body, keep Geist (3.1)
Density options	official (Mar 2025)	Idea only (4.1)
Server icons: rounded squares that become circles on hover	third-party analysis	Optional (4.1)

6.2 2026 trends

Trend roundups and blog posts: direction, not proof.

TREND	EVIDENCE	CIG DECISION
Warm soft white as the quiet choice	Pantone 2026 Color of the Year: Cloud Dancer 11-4201, #FOEEE9, announced 4 Dec 2025, the first white in the program's history	Adopt: Cloud theme
Teal and “calm earth”: khaki, jade, walnut	WGSN and Coloro: Transformative Teal; paint brands move to jade, walnut, khaki	Validates the teal brand; adopt Evergreen and Cloud's walnut secondary
Fatigue with dark-only products	opinion pieces on a UI “cleanse” away from dark-mode overload	At least two light themes should ship
Variable fonts are the default; Inter and Geist named as neutral UI sans	multiple 2026 type roundups	Keep Geist; no font change
Monospace as brand voice	2026 font-trend pieces	Already CIG's identity
16px body floor, line height at least 1.4, rem sizing, APCA discussion	typography guides	16px chat body; APCA as a later check

6.3 Reference palettes and sources

Catpuccin (Mocha, Latte), Rose Pine (and Dawn), Tokyo Night and Gruvbox (light) were read from their official repositories, so the reference values in section 7 are exact for those themes. They are published under open licenses and used as starting points: every CIG theme is a re-mapping onto our tokens, tuned for contrast, not a copy. **Tar, Chocolate and Espresso** were sampled from the two brown palette images shared during this project (JPEGs). The label “Pantone 4975 CP” is printed on the chart next to Tar; a color sampled from a JPEG is not an official Pantone value, so the hex codes in section 7 are the sampled ones.

Sources: Discord support and blog, Engadget and PC Gamer (25 Mar 2025), community color extractions, Pantone and trend roundups, the official palette repositories and 2026 typography roundups. Full list with links: [Markdown](#), section 6.4.

7 Theme catalog

7.1 How the themes are built

17 themes: 11 dark and 6 light. Six ship today (Abyss and Ember, then Onyx, Mocha, Amethyst and Espresso since PR #68); Daylight is the proposal in 5.2; the other 10 are candidates. Each maps a reference palette onto the 11 tokens, then colors are nudged **in lightness only** (hue and saturation kept) until they meet these targets on page, surface and raised. Every adjustment is listed under its theme.

TOKEN	TARGET
fg	7:1 on page and surface (AAA), 4.5:1 on raised
muted, brand, brand-2, danger	4.5:1 on all three surfaces
brand as a button	page text on brand 4.5:1, and on brand/90 (hover) 4.5:1
warning, online	3:1 on all three surfaces (they are dots, not text)

All 17 themes meet every target. That is **by construction**, since the colors were tuned to them: it shows the palettes are internally consistent, not that they look good, so each shipped theme still needs the manual pass.

7.2 At a glance

	page	surface	raised	slate	fg	muted	brand	brand-2	danger	warning	online
Abyss dark · CIG brand	#0d0e18	#1a1c2e	#252840	#4a4e72	#edeffb	#9aa0c8	#5ead4	#a079f8	#ff6467	#fbbf24	#05df72
Ember dark · CIG brand	#0d0e18	#1a1c2e	#252840	#4a4e72	#edeffb	#9aa0c8	#f87171	#fb923c	#ff4d79	#fbbf24	#05df72
Daylight light · CIG brand	#edeffb	#ffffff	#e2e5f6	#4a4e72	#0d0e18	#4d5278	#0d6b63	#6d28d9	#b91c1c	#b45309	#15803d
Onyx dark · Discord	#000000	#111214	#1e1f22	#4e5058	#f2f3f5	#b5bac1	#6f7af4	#eb459e	#f3474a	#f0b232	#23a55a
Ash dark · Discord	#2f3136	#36393f	#40444b	#72767d	#dcdde	#b9bbbe	#9fafe6	#32bbff	#f69696	#faa61a	#43b581
Midnight dark · Tokyo Night	#16161e	#1a1b26	#292e42	#565f89	#c0caf5	#a9b1d6	#7aa2f7	#bb9af7	#f7768e	#e0af68	#9ece6a
Mocha dark · Catppuccin	#181825	#1e1e2e	#313244	#585b70	#cdd6f4	#a6adc8	#cba6f7	#f5c2e7	#f38ba8	#f9e2af	#a6e3a1
Evergreen dark · 2026 calm earth	#0e1714	#141f1b	#1d2c26	#46605a	#e8f0ea	#9db3a8	#5cc9a7	#d6936f	#f0716f	#f2c14e	#8bd450
Tar dark · Browns	#280b0d	#34120e	#491f11	#6f2f16	#f1e5d7	#bda083	#cf9154	#da7663	#f2677f	#f2b93b	#6fcf6a
Chocolate dark · Browns	#3f0110	#3c1321	#492529	#5c4034	#efe3d0	#c0a182	#c09a6b	#cd8577	#f16b80	#f2b93b	#6fcf6a
Espresso dark · Browns	#371b1a	#3c3034	#483b32	#6e5a48	#f1e8d8	#b1a696	#c3b090	#db94a3	#ff846c	#f2b93b	#6fcf6a
Amethyst dark · Original (purple)	#130b24	#1c1336	#2a1d4d	#4b3b7a	#f1ebff	#b3a5d9	#b794ff	#f472b6	#ff5f5f	#fbbf24	#4ade80
Chalk light · Discord	#f2f3f5	#ffffff	#e3e5e8	#80848e	#313338	#5c5e66	#3e4df0	#c31572	#c42429	#ad790d	#209652
Cloud light · Pantone 2026	#f0eee9	#faf9f6	#e6e3dc	#8a857b	#26241f	#5f5b52	#116871	#9c512d	#b83729	#b0741e	#2f8f5b
Latte light · Catppuccin	#e6e9ef	#eff1f5	#dce0e8	#9ca0b0	#484b63	#5f6275	#7c24ed	#0a55ea	#c50e35	#b27117	#3a9027
Dawn light · Rose Pine	#faf4ed	#ffffaf3	#f2e9e1	#9893a5	#464261	#6a6683	#6e5888	#ba3f3a	#a44f67	#bf7614	#2f8f68
Parchment light · Gruvbox	#ebdbb2	#fbf1c7	#d5c4a1	#928374	#3c3836	#5a514a	#065b6b	#813966	#9d0006	#966211	#746f0d

7.3 - 7.19 Theme sheets

Each sheet: a preview drawn from the theme's real tokens, every token with its contrast, where the palette comes from, and what was tuned. The CSS for each theme is in the Markdown and in theme-catalog.css.

Abyss **AS-BUILT** DARK · CIG brand
Ink-navy instrument panel, teal signal. The default.



TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#0d0e18	page background
surface	#1a1c2e	panels, rail, cards
raised	#252840	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#4a4e72	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#edeffb	primary text · 12.6:1
muted	#9aa0c8	secondary text, solid · 5.7:1
brand	#5eead4	primary accent · 9.7:1 · button 13.0 / hover 10.6
brand-2	#a079f8	secondary accent · 4.5:1
danger	#ff6467	errors, blocked · 5.0:1
warning	#fbbf24	idle, caution · 8.6:1 dot
online	#05df72	online dot · 8.1:1 dot

Reference. All values from globals.css on main (PR #65): the six original tokens (brand-2 lightened from #8b5cf6, which was 4.0:1 on surface), plus raised, muted, warning and the status tokens danger and online. Those two carry Tailwind v4's red-400 and green-400, defined in OKLCH; the hex shown is the sRGB approximation (the red slightly exceeds the sRGB gamut).

Tuned for contrast: nothing, the reference values already meet the targets.

Ember **AS-BUILT** DARK · CIG brand
Same dark navy base with a warm coral and orange accent.

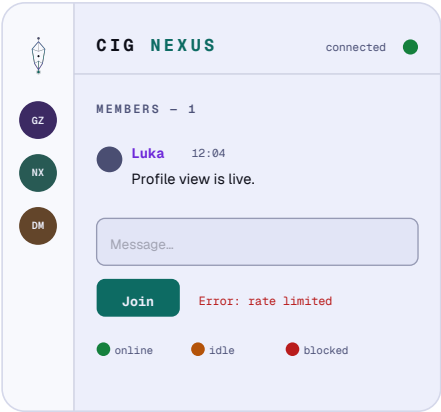


TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#0d0e18	page background
surface	#1a1c2e	panels, rail, cards
raised	#252840	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#4a4e72	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#edeffb	primary text · 12.6:1
muted	#9aa0c8	secondary text, solid · 5.7:1
brand	#f87171	primary accent · 5.2:1 · button 6.9 / hover 5.8
brand-2	#fb923c	secondary accent · 6.4:1
danger	#ff4d79	errors, blocked · 4.5:1
warning	#fbbf24	idle, caution · 8.6:1 dot
online	#05df72	online dot · 8.1:1 dot

Reference. As on main (PR #65): Ember overrides only brand, brand-2 and danger; every other token inherits Abyss. Its own danger (#ff4d79) replaces the red-400 that was nearly identical to its coral brand.

Tuned for contrast: nothing, the reference values already meet the targets.

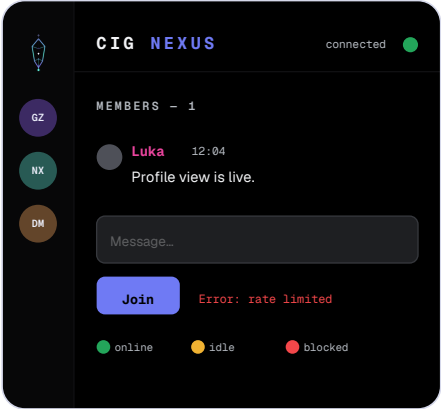
Daylight **PROPOSED** LIGHT · CIG brand
Cool lavender-white page, deep teal and violet. The neutral light theme.



TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#edeffb	page background
surface	#ffffff	panels, rail, cards
raised	#e2e5f6	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#4a4e72	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#0d0e18	primary text · 15.3:1
muted	#4d5278	secondary text, solid · 6.0:1
brand	#0d6b63	primary accent · 5.1:1 · button 5.6 / hover 4.6
brand-2	#6d28d9	secondary accent · 5.7:1
danger	#b91c1c	errors, blocked · 5.2:1
warning	#b45309	idle, caution · 4.0:1 dot
online	#15803d	online dot · 4.0:1 dot

Reference. Our own design: page and fg swapped from Abyss; brand and brand-2 deepened for contrast.
Tuned for contrast: nothing, the reference values already meet the targets.

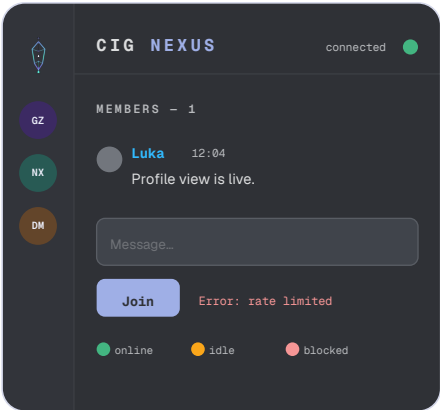
Onyx **AS-BUILT** DARK · Discord
Pure black page, near-black panels, blurple and fuchsia. Best on OLED.



TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#000000	page background
surface	#111214	panels, rail, cards
raised	#1e1f22	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#4e5058	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#f2f3f5	primary text · 14.8:1
muted	#b5bac1	secondary text, solid · 8.4:1
brand	#6f7af4	primary accent · 4.5:1 · button 5.8 / hover 4.8
brand-2	#eb459e	secondary accent · 4.6:1
danger	#f3474a	errors, blocked · 4.6:1
warning	#f0b232	idle, caution · 8.7:1 dot
online	#23a55a	online dot · 5.2:1 dot

Reference. True-black page is Discord Onyx (official). #1e1f22 is Discord's darkest dark surface and #f2f3f5 / #23a55a its red / green (community-extracted). Blurple #5865f2 is Discord's brand color. The idle yellow #f0b232 is commonly cited but was not confirmed in the sources read. Panel steps and the fuchsia pairing are ours.
Tuned for contrast (lightness only): brand #5865f2 → #6f7af4; danger #f2f3f5 → #f3474a.

Ash **PROPOSED** DARK · Discord
Soft mid-gray, easy on the eyes for long sessions. Old-blurple and sky blue.



TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#2f3136	page background
surface	#36393f	panels, rail, cards
raised	#40444b	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#72767d	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#dcddde	primary text · 7.2:1
muted	#b9bbbe	secondary text, solid · 5.1:1
brand	#9fafe6	primary accent · 4.5:1 · button 6.0 / hover 5.2
brand-2	#32bbff	secondary accent · 4.5:1
danger	#f69696	errors, blocked · 4.5:1
warning	#faa61a	idle, caution · 4.9:1 dot
online	#43b581	online dot · 3.8:1 dot

Reference. Discord's pre-2022 dark palette (the original dark that Discord now calls Ash), recalled from the legacy UI and partly confirmed by community palette sites. The exact hexes of today's Ash were not published in the sources read, so treat this as inspired by, not a copy. Text and accents are tuned.

Tuned for contrast (lightness only): brand #7289da → #9fafe6; brand-2 #00a8fc → #32bbff; danger #f04747 → #f69696.

Midnight **PROPOSED** DARK · Tokyo Night
Deep indigo-blue with periwinkle and lilac. Calm, focused, a little cinematic.



TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#16161e	page background
surface	#1a1b26	panels, rail, cards
raised	#292e42	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#565f89	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#c0caf5	primary text · 8.3:1
muted	#a9b1d6	secondary text, solid · 6.4:1
brand	#7aa2f7	primary accent · 5.3:1 · button 7.1 / hover 6.0
brand-2	#bb9af7	secondary accent · 5.8:1
danger	#f7768e	errors, blocked · 5.1:1
warning	#e0af68	idle, caution · 6.7:1 dot
online	#9ece6a	online dot · 7.3:1 dot

Reference. Tokyo Night (night variant), read from the official repository: bg #1a1b26, bg_dark #16161e, bg_highlight #292e42, fg #c0caf5, fg_dark #a9b1d6, comment #565f89, blue #7aa2f7, magenta #bb9af7, red #f7768e, yellow #e0af68, green #9ece6a.

Tuned for contrast: nothing, the reference values already meet the targets.

Mocha **AS-BUILT** DARK · Catppuccin
Warm, soft purple-brown darks with mauve and pink pastels.

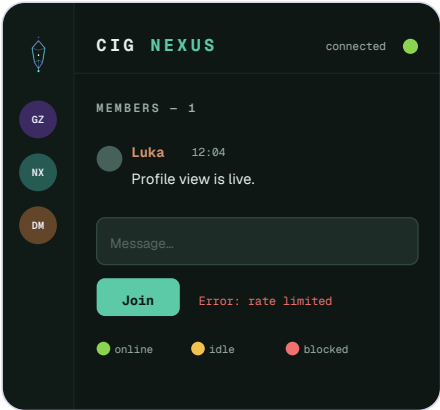


TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#181825	page background
surface	#1e1e2e	panels, rail, cards
raised	#313244	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#585b70	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#cdd6f4	primary text · 8.7:1
muted	#a6adc8	secondary text, solid · 5.6:1
brand	#cba6f7	primary accent · 6.2:1 · button 8.6 / hover 7.2
brand-2	#f5c2e7	secondary accent · 8.2:1
danger	#f38ba8	errors, blocked · 5.4:1
warning	#f9e2af	idle, caution · 9.9:1 dot
online	#a6e3a1	online dot · 8.5:1 dot

Reference. Catppuccin Mocha, read from the official palette.json: mantle #181825, base #1e1e2e, surface0 #313244, text #cdd6f4, subtext0 #a6adc8, mauve #cba6f7, pink #f5c2e7, red #f38ba8, yellow #f9e2af, green #a6e3a1.

Tuned for contrast: nothing, the reference values already meet the targets.

Evergreen **PROPOSED** DARK · 2026 calm earth
Forest-black with jade and a walnut-clay secondary. Organic and quiet.



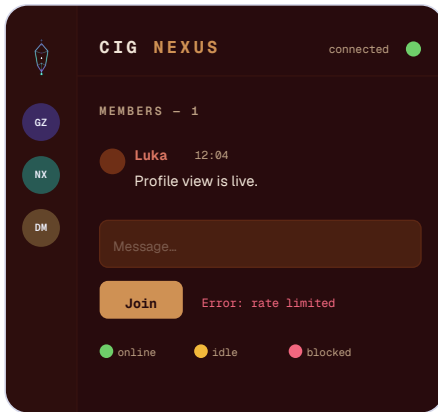
TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#0e1714	page background
surface	#141f1b	panels, rail, cards
raised	#1d2c26	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#46605a	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#e8f0ea	primary text · 12.6:1
muted	#9db3a8	secondary text, solid · 6.6:1
brand	#5cc9a7	primary accent · 7.2:1 · button 9.0 / hover 7.5
brand-2	#d6936f	secondary accent · 5.7:1
danger	#f0716f	errors, blocked · 5.1:1
warning	#f2c14e	idle, caution · 8.7:1 dot
online	#8bd450	online dot · 8.1:1 dot

Reference. Original palette from the 2026 calm-earth direction (jade, khaki, walnut, teal). No third-party source.

Tuned for contrast: nothing, the reference values already meet the targets.

Tar PROPOSED DARK · Browns

Near-black red-brown, cream text, orange-tan. Warm, dense, a little cinematic.



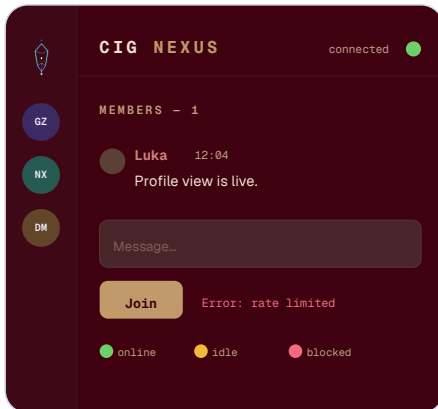
TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#280b0d	page background
surface	#34120e	panels, rail, cards
raised	#491f11	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#6f2f16	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#f1e5d7	primary text · 11.4:1
muted	#bda083	secondary text, solid · 5.7:1
brand	#cf9154	primary accent · 5.3:1 · button 6.8 / hover 5.8
brand-2	#da7663	secondary accent · 4.5:1
danger	#f2677f	errors, blocked · 4.7:1
warning	#f2b93b	idle, caution · 7.9:1 dot
online	#6fcf6a	online dot · 7.3:1 dot

Reference. Sampled from the brown palette chart you shared (a JPEG): Tar #280b0d (the chart prints it as Pantone 4975 CP, but a sampled JPEG is not an official Pantone value), Walnut #491f11, Stewed #6f2f16, Milk #f1e5d7, Tan #cf9154. page = Tar, raised = Walnut, slate = Stewed, fg = Milk, brand = Tan. The surface step (a Tar and Walnut blend), muted, brand-2 (Mahogany's hue, lightened) and the status colors are ours.

Tuned for contrast (lightness only): brand-2 #d4604a → #da7663.

Chocolate PROPOSED DARK · Browns

Wine-dark chocolate with camel. Rich and a little plummy.



TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#3f0110	page background
surface	#3c1321	panels, rail, cards
raised	#492529	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#5c4034	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#efe3d0	primary text · 10.5:1
muted	#c0a182	secondary text, solid · 5.5:1
brand	#c09a6b	primary accent · 5.1:1 · button 6.6 / hover 5.5
brand-2	#cd8577	secondary accent · 4.6:1
danger	#f16b80	errors, blocked · 4.5:1
warning	#f2b93b	idle, caution · 7.5:1 dot
online	#6fcf6a	online dot · 6.8:1 dot

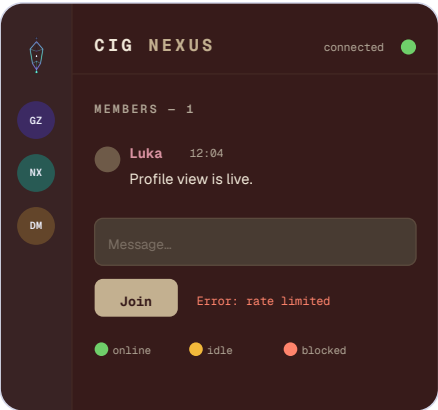
Reference. Sampled from the brown names chart you shared (a JPEG): Chocolate #3f0110, Dark Chocolate #3c1321, Dark Brown #5c4034, Camel #c09a6b, Chestnut #944536. page = Chocolate, surface = Dark Chocolate, slate = Dark Brown, brand = Camel, brand-2 = Chestnut. raised is a Dark Chocolate and Dark Brown blend; fg, muted and the status colors are ours.

Tuned for contrast (lightness only): brand-2 #944536 → #cd8577; danger #f0647a → #f16b80.

Espresso

AS-BUILT DARK · Browns

Neutral mocha-gray browns with sand and a rose accent. Calm and low-chroma.



TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#371b1a	page background
surface	#3c3034	panels, rail, cards
raised	#483b32	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#6e5a48	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#f1e8d8	primary text · 8.9:1
muted	#b1a696	secondary text, solid · 4.5:1
brand	#c3b090	primary accent · 5.1:1 · button 7.4 / hover 6.3
brand-2	#db94a3	secondary accent · 4.5:1
danger	#ff846c	errors, blocked · 4.5:1
warning	#f2b93b	idle, caution · 6.0:1 dot
online	#6fcf6a	online dot · 5.6:1 dot

Reference. Sampled from the same chart: Espresso #371b1a, Dark Mocha #3c3034, French Mole #483b32, Khaki #c3b090, Hershey's #43141a. page = Espresso, surface = Dark Mocha, raised = French Mole, brand = Khaki (low-chroma on purpose). brand-2 takes Hershey's hue, lightened; fg, muted, slate and the status colors are ours.

Tuned for contrast (lightness only): muted #a89c8a → #b1a696; brand-2 #cf6f84 → #db94a3; danger #ff6a4d → #ff846c.

Amethyst

AS-BUILT DARK · Original (purple)

Violet-forward dark: deep purple surfaces, lilac primary, rose secondary.

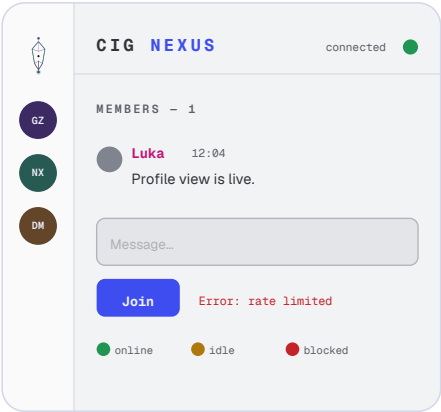


TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#130b24	page background
surface	#1c1336	panels, rail, cards
raised	#2a1d4d	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#4b3b7a	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#f1ebff	primary text · 13.1:1
muted	#b3a5d9	secondary text, solid · 6.7:1
brand	#b794ff	primary accent · 6.3:1 · button 7.9 / hover 6.6
brand-2	#f472b6	secondary accent · 5.7:1
danger	#ff5f5f	errors, blocked · 5.1:1
warning	#fbbf24	idle, caution · 9.1:1 dot
online	#4ade80	online dot · 8.7:1 dot

Reference. Original palette, no third-party source: purple-black surfaces with a lilac primary and a rose secondary, the violet-forward counterpart to Abyss's navy and teal.

Tuned for contrast: nothing, the reference values already meet the targets.

Chalk **PROPOSED** LIGHT · Discord
Neutral cool white and gray, blurple accent. Familiar and crisp.

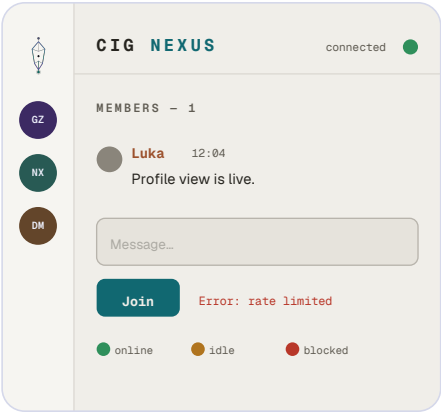


TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#f2f3f5	page background
surface	#ffffff	panels, rail, cards
raised	#e3e5e8	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#80848e	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#313338	primary text · 10.0:1
muted	#5c5e66	secondary text, solid · 5.1:1
brand	#3e4df0	primary accent · 4.7:1 · button 5.4 / hover 4.5
brand-2	#c31572	secondary accent · 4.5:1
danger	#c42429	errors, blocked · 4.6:1
warning	#ad790d	idle, caution · 3.0:1 dot
online	#209652	online dot · 3.0:1 dot

Reference. Discord Light surfaces (#ffffff, #f2f3f5, #e3e5e8; community-extracted) and the blurple brand accent. Text color and the fuchsia pairing are ours.

Tuned for contrast (lightness only): brand #5865f2 → #3e4df0; brand-2 #eb459e → #c31572; danger #da373c → #c42429; warning #f0b232 → #ad790d; online #23a55a → #209652.

Cloud **PROPOSED** LIGHT · Pantone 2026
Warm soft white, charcoal text, deep teal. The 2026 quiet-luxury look.

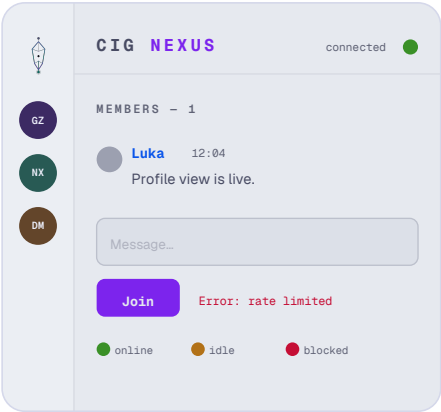


TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#f0eee9	page background
surface	#faf9f6	panels, rail, cards
raised	#e6e3dc	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#8a857b	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#26241f	primary text · 12.1:1
muted	#5f5b52	secondary text, solid · 5.3:1
brand	#116871	primary accent · 5.1:1 · button 5.6 / hover 4.6
brand-2	#9c512d	secondary accent · 4.5:1
danger	#b83729	errors, blocked · 4.5:1
warning	#b0741e	idle, caution · 3.1:1 dot
online	#2f8f5b	online dot · 3.2:1 dot

Reference. Pantone Cloud Dancer #F0EEE9 as the page color (confirmed). Charcoal text, the Transformative-Teal-inspired accent and the walnut secondary are ours.

Tuned for contrast (lightness only): brand #13747d → #116871; brand-2 #a4552f → #9c512d; danger #c0392b → #b83729; warning #b7791f → #b0741e.

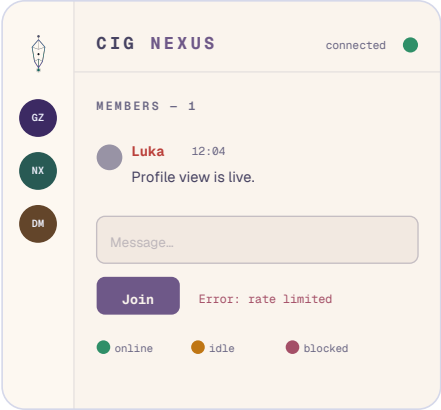
Latte **PROPOSED** LIGHT · Catppuccin
Cool lavender-gray light with mauve and blue. Soft and tidy.



TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#e6e9ef	page background
surface	#eff1f5	panels, rail, cards
raised	#dce0e8	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#9ca0b0	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#484b63	primary text · 6.4:1
muted	#5f6275	secondary text, solid · 4.5:1
brand	#7c24ed	primary accent · 4.8:1 · button 5.2 / hover 4.5
brand-2	#0a55ea	secondary accent · 4.5:1
danger	#c50e35	errors, blocked · 4.5:1
warning	#b27117	idle, caution · 3.0:1 dot
online	#3a9027	online dot · 3.1:1 dot

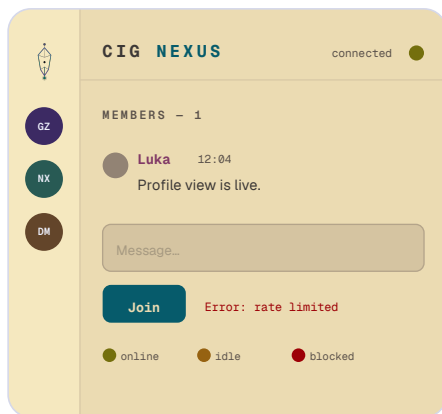
Reference. Catppuccin Latte, read from the official palette.json: mantle #e6e9ef, base #eff1f5, crust #dce0e8, text #4c4f69, subtext0 #6c6f85, mauve #8839ef, blue #1e66f5, red #d20f39, yellow #df8e1d, green #40a02b.
Tuned for contrast (lightness only): fg #4c4f69 → #484b63; muted #6c6f85 → #5f6275; brand #8839ef → #7c24ed; brand-2 #1e66f5 → #0a55ea; danger #d20f39 → #c50e35; warning #df8e1d → #b27117; online #40a02b → #3a9027.

Dawn **PROPOSED** LIGHT · Rose Pine
Warm cream with plum text, iris and rose. Gentle, a bit romantic.



TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#faf4ed	page background
surface	#fffaf3	panels, rail, cards
raised	#f2e9e1	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#9893a5	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#464261	primary text · 7.9:1
muted	#6a6683	secondary text, solid · 4.6:1
brand	#6e5888	primary accent · 5.1:1 · button 5.6 / hover 4.5
brand-2	#ba3f3a	secondary accent · 4.5:1
danger	#a44f67	errors, blocked · 4.5:1
warning	#bf7614	idle, caution · 3.0:1 dot
online	#2f8f68	online dot · 3.3:1 dot

Reference. Rose Pine Dawn, read from the official palette: base #faf4ed, surface #fffaf3, overlay #f2e9e1, subtle #797593, text #464261, iris #907aa9, rose #d7827e, love #b4637a, gold #ea9d34. Rose Pine has no green, so the online color is ours.
Tuned for contrast (lightness only): muted #797593 → #6a6683; brand #907aa9 → #6e5888; brand-2 #d7827e → #ba3f3a; danger #b4637a → #a44f67; warning #ea9d34 → #bf7614.



TOKEN	HEX	ROLE · CONTRAST (min over page, surface, raised)
page	#ebdbb2	page background
surface	#fbf1c7	panels, rail, cards
raised	#d5c4a1	hover, selected, input fill
slate	#928374	borders and chrome (/20 to /50)
fg	#3c3836	primary text · 6.8:1
muted	#5a514a	secondary text, solid · 4.5:1
brand	#065b6b	primary accent · 4.5:1 · button 5.6 / hover 4.7
brand-2	#813966	secondary accent · 4.5:1
danger	#9d0006	errors, blocked · 5.0:1
warning	#966211	idle, caution · 3.0:1 dot
online	#746f0d	online dot · 3.0:1 dot

Reference. Gruvbox Light, read from the official repository: light0 #fbf1c7, light1 #ebdbb2, light2 #d5c4a1, dark1 #3c3836, faded_blue #076678, faded_purple #8f3f71, faded_red #9d0006, faded_yellow #b57614, faded_green #79740e.

Tuned for contrast (lightness only): muted #665c54 → #5a514a; brand #076678 → #065b6b; brand-2 #8f3f71 → #813966; warning #b57614 → #966211; online #79740e → #746f0d.

7.20 Shipping order

Every shipped theme costs one manual pass over every view (no visual-regression suite) and a place in the picker.

Shipped (dark batch 1, PR #68): Abyss, Ember, Onyx, Mocha, Amethyst, Espresso. It differs from the first recommendation (Abyss, Ember, Onyx, Mocha plus two light themes): it was chosen from the directions you preferred, and keeps to one brown, as advised.

Next, after the readiness work of 5.4: the first light pair, Daylight and Cloud (the neutral inversion of the brand, and the 2026 warm white).

Later, in any order: Midnight, Evergreen, Ash and the two other browns (Tar, Chocolate) among the dark themes; Chalk, Latte, Dawn and Parchment among the light ones. The browns are close to each other (Tar the red-black with an orange-tan accent, Chocolate the wine-plum with camel, Espresso the neutral mocha-gray with sand), so add at most one more. Evergreen and Parchment use the most unusual hues: ship them after the themed Mark lands.

7.21 Picker and system mode

- **Picker** [as-built since PR #68]: grouped by mode (Dark, Light), with each theme's swatch (accent and secondary). Group headings appear only once the registry has more than one mode, so there are none while every theme is dark.
- **System mode** [proposed]: Discord's "Sync with computer" with a separate choice of light and dark theme. Data model: theme_mode (manual or system), theme_light, theme_dark, next to today's theme and theme_sync_enabled.
- **Open problem:** appearance-design.md §3.2 avoids a blocking inline script and renders the theme from a server-read cookie, which cannot know prefers-color-scheme on the very first request. Options: a tiny inline script; a Sec-CH-Prefers-Color-Scheme client hint (Chromium only) plus a cookie from the second visit; or one flash on first load. Needs an explicit decision and supersedes that document's scope-out.

8 Governance

- `web/app/globals.css` and `web/lib/appearance/themes.ts` are the source of truth for colors. This document follows them; if they disagree, the code wins.
- The catalog files (`theme-catalog.css`, `theme-catalog.json`) and section 7 agree at v0.4. If a theme value changes, update all three in the same PR.
- Any new logo file is added to the table in 1.2 in the same PR.
- Tests guard this system: the opacity-tier allowlist (PR #67) and the theme drift and contrast tests (PR #68). Adding a theme or changing a token means updating them in the same PR; they fail on purpose when a value drifts.
- A token or typography change updates this document and `CHANGELOG.md` in the same PR.
- **No two utilities of the same property in one** `className` (for example `text-fg/70` and `text-brand`) unless they are mutually exclusive branches of a condition. Tailwind emits rules in an order that depends on class names, so which one wins can change when a class is renamed (PR #63 hit this once). Worth adding to `CLAUDE.md`; a lint rule for conflicting utilities is worth investigating for Tailwind v4.
- This PDF is a presentation copy, never the source. Regenerate it from `docs/design/brand-guidelines.md`.

9 Open decisions

Decided since the first draft: the token names page, fg, brand, brand-2 (PR #63); the guild icon fix (PR #61); the charter is versioned in `docs/design/` (PR #62); the v0.2 tokens and color-scheme: dark (PR #65); the muted migration and its guard test (PR #67); the first dark batch with drift and contrast tests (PR #68); the transparent mark in the UI (PR #69); 16px message bodies and inputs (PR #70).

#	DECISION	RECOMMENDATION
1	Name and id for the neutral light theme	daylight (alternatives: paper, light)
2	The light-theme readiness plan of 5.4 (L1 to L4)	Adopt in that order; L2 and L3 may share a PR.
3	Themed Mark gradient from brand to brand-2 (Abyss loses the blue top stop)	Yes; judge it in all six shipped themes. If the Abyss logo matters, add a fixed third stop.
4	Mark glow: a data-mode attribute for dark only, or no glow	data-mode if cheap (the registry has mode); otherwise no glow.
5	The five red-300 uses (5.3, item 9)	text-danger, in PR L3.
6	Author name at 12px or 14px (2.6, item 8)	Keep 12px unless the author line feels small; text-sm is a one-line change.
7	Bio display (14 / 22, fg) and the 10px and 9px micro badges (12px) from 3.1	Yes, as a separate small PR.
8	Retire <code>lockup.svg</code> / <code>lockup.png</code>	Yes: replace with the new lockups.
9	System mode and its first-paint behavior (7.21)	Decide after the first light pair ships; do not block themes on it.
10	Clear space and minimum sizes (1.4)	Accept as written; revisit after seeing the mark at 24px in the UI.